

Alex Rivera

Auckland

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Dear Hiring Team,

Introduction

I came to software from hospitality: I ran a busy café's ordering system, taught myself Python to automate the stock count, then went back to study computer science. I finished my degree in 2020 and have been a software engineer for four years, the last two shipping language model features in production, and I am now at Humongous Insurance in Auckland. My working principle is to make the software show its working, so people can trust what it decides.

I am applying for the Data and AI Engineer role at Trey Research. Trey Research runs public-policy surveys for New Zealand government agencies, and what draws me to this role is the assistant that summarises thousands of open-text survey answers and links each finding back to the answers behind it. Building that with the researchers, and making it accurate enough to stand behind, is the work I want to do.

Why I Am a Good Fit

The role asks for two or more years in software or data engineering, and I have four, with the last two spent shipping language model features to production rather than prototypes. It also asks for strong Python and SQL: I wrote Python tooling that reconciles supplier invoices against bookings for the finance team, and built booking and itinerary features on PostgreSQL. My language model work is the closest match, a claims-intake assistant that reads customer emails and PDFs, checks the output against JSON schemas and routes over 2,000 claims a month, backed by a 300-claim evaluation set that cut misrouted claims from 9% to 3%. Because researchers have to be able to trust what the model says, I built step-by-step tracing so claims staff could see why a claim was routed the way it was.

Additional Information

I currently hold a valid open work visa valid until June 2028. I am available to start work after serving my 2-week notice period.

Kind regards,

Alex Rivera